Year 8 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

Version 3.1, October 2026. Use with `Y08/Y08_Student_Paper_v3.1`. Version 3.1 is version 2 with the third reading text (Part C) removed: the listening, writing, maths, science and interview are unchanged from version 2. The reading paper is now Parts A and B (16 marks) in the same time as before. Do not mix papers and instructions from different versions: the question numbers, marks and band guides differ.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y08_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

For students applying to join **Year 8** (age 12 to 13 on 1 September). A Year 8 entrant from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 6** (the end of primary school) and is the same age as a student starting Grade 7 (初一). The version 2 maths paper starts at the level expected on entry to Year 8 (the end of UK Year 7) and goes well beyond it, into Year 8 content, so expanding and factorising, equations with the unknown on both sides, inequalities, index laws, standard form, probability as a number and the mean from a frequency table **may not have been taught yet** (Section 4). A Year 8 entrant has usually done **no secondary science**: the science paper tests UK Year 7 content, so read the science score with the NT notes in Section 5. Background, the English bands and the decision guide are in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Notes
1	Welcome	2	Assessor	Student paper, pencil, rubber, ruler	Script in Section 2
2	Listening (paper pages 2 to 5)	about 16 (recording)	Assessor plays the recording, or reads each script twice	These instructions, Section 3.1; the recording	Part A: a conversation with two voices. Part B: a short talk. Can be done with a small group
3	Reading paper (pages 6 to 9)	15	Student works alone; assessor times	Clock or timer	Do not read the texts aloud
4	Writing (pages 10 to 11)	10	Student works alone		Choose one of two tasks
5	Break	5		Water	
6	Maths (pages 12 to 17)	25	Student; assessor may read questions aloud	No calculator, no protractor	Section A Fluency, Section B Word questions, Section C Applied problems
7	Science (pages 18 to 20)	8	Student; assessor may read questions aloud		
8	Interview, opening with sentence reading	15	Interviewer, 1:1	Interviewer guide, Interview sheet, Reading front sheet, Sentence reading guide and card, a plain card	Sentence reading starts at **Level 7** (sentence 19)
	Total	**about 95**			Including the welcome and the break. Plus the parent conversation (about 15 minutes, separate)

Marks go on the **grading sheet** (listening, writing, maths and science), the **Reading front sheet** (reading) and the **Interview sheet** (speaking).

For each candidate:

- the Year 8 student paper, version 3.1 (20 pages, A4; print it double-sided, so that the listening Part B pages, 4 and 5, face each other);
- the grading sheet (`Y08/Y08_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`);
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`);
- the Interview sheet for Years 7 to 10 (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y7_Y10`);
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`);
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

For the room (print once, laminate the cards):

- these instructions;
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y7_Y10`);
- `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`;
- the sentence reading card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`; laminate it);
- the other equipment in the table above: a pencil, a rubber and a ruler for each candidate, a clock or timer, a plain card to cover the sentences, and water for the break.

Version 3.1 compared with version 1

Part	Version 1	Version 3.1
Listening	One conversation, 8 marks, 5 minutes	**Part A** is the version 1 conversation, unchanged (questions 1 to 8). **Part B** is new: a short academic talk (questions 9 to 16). 16 marks, about 12 minutes
Reading	Three texts, 24 marks, 12 minutes	**Part A** is version 1 Part A (the notice). **Part B** is version 1 Part C (the sleep article), renumbered 7 to 13. There is no Part C: the version 2 feature article above age level is not used. Two texts, 16 marks, 15 minutes
Maths	Number problems and word problems, 30 marks, 20 minutes	Aimed at the higher end, in three sections: **Fluency** (10 marks), **Word questions** (8) and **Applied problems** (12). 30 marks, 25 minutes, with three sub-scores
Writing, science, interview		Unchanged

2. Before you start

Welcome script. Say, in a calm, friendly voice:

> "Hello, I'm … . Welcome to our school. Today you will do some activities in English: listening, reading, writing, maths and science. Then we will have a chat. The activities help us get to know you and find the right support for you. Some questions are easy and some are hard. That is fine. Do your best, and it is OK if you cannot answer everything. In maths and science I can read a question to you. In the English parts I cannot explain words, because we want to see your English. You can always ask me to say an instruction again. Do you have any questions?"

Pace of speech. Many Year 8 students are still learning English: speak steadily, slightly slower than normal speech, about 160 words a minute, when you give instructions, read the listening scripts and read maths and science questions aloud. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared. The listening recording is paced the same way.

Access rules (the same in every year group; details in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 7)

	English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	**Maths and science**
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate or read the reading texts aloud. You may repeat instructions in English.	Read any question aloud in English, as often as asked, and point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Mark the question **L** in the margin. The mark still counts.
Answers	**All answers must be in English** (numbers, ticks, drawings and working count). An answer in Chinese scores 0.	**All answers must be in English**, including the explanations in maths questions 14, 17b and 18. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0. Short phrases and numbers are enough.
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List NT topics and L questions on the grading sheet.

- **Extra time or a reader** for a known need is allowed; record it on the grading sheet.
- **Stopping.** The student may stop any section when they have done what they can. **Listening:** if you are assessing one student who clearly understood very little of Part A (a student new to English, for example), you may leave out Part B: say "Thank you, that is fine," and record "Part B not given" on the grading sheet; the band then comes from Part A. With a group, read Part B to everyone and tell them it is hard. **Reading:** Part B is harder than Part A: if the student is clearly stuck, let them stop and say "Thank you, that is fine." **Writing:** if the student cannot write in English, ask them to write any words they know, or a plan; do not score Chinese writing, but keep it. Never push a distressed student: take a break or stop, and record it on the grading sheet.
- **Keeping the student at ease.** Explain the order of the morning and the break. Sit beside, not opposite, for the interview. Praise effort, not answers ("Thank you, you are working hard"). Do not show surprise at mistakes. Keep the timer out of the student's line of sight, and give a calm two-minute warning near the end of each timed part. Many Year 8 students have just left primary school: tell them that listening Part B, reading Part B and the end of each maths section are meant to be hard, that the science has topics they may not have studied yet, and that this is expected.

3. English

3.1 Listening (about 16 minutes with the recording, 16 marks)

There are two parts. **Part A** is the everyday conversation from version 1, unchanged. **Part B** is a short talk at the level of a lesson for a fluent student of 12 to 13.

Recording. A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y08/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. Read live at the recording's pace, one reading of Part A takes about 2 minutes 17 seconds and of Part B about 2 minutes 56 seconds, with the pauses: use this to check your own pace. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script. Play Part A and Part B as separate tracks if you may stop after Part A; otherwise the full track plays both.

Part A: Mei and Amir talk about the charity fair (questions 1 to 8, about 5 minutes)

Say: "Turn to the Listening pages. There are two parts. In Part A, I am going to read a conversation between two students, Mei and Amir. I will read it two times. First, read questions 1 to 8." Give the student **one minute** to look at questions 1 to 8 (pages 2 and 3). Then say: "Now listen. You can answer while I read."

Read it twice at the steady pace in Section 2 (about 160 words a minute). You read both parts. Say the speaker's name before each turn, a little more quietly, and make the two voices slightly different. Pause for about 3 seconds at

each [pause]. After the first reading, say "Now listen again" and read it again. After the second reading, give 30 seconds to finish. Do not repeat any part, and do not explain any word.

Script: Mei and Amir talk about the charity fair

Amir: Mei, have you decided what our class is going to sell at the charity fair?

Mei: Yes! We wanted to sell cakes, but the Year 9 classes are already doing that. So we're going to sell plants instead: small ones, in pots. **[pause]**

Amir: Plants? OK. When is the fair? Is it this Friday?

Mei: No, it's next Saturday, from ten in the morning until two in the afternoon. **[pause]**

Amir: And where is our stall? Next to the music stage again?

Mei: No. Last year it was so loud there that nobody could hear us. This year we're by the main gate. **[pause]**

Amir: What can I do to help?

Mei: Can you make the price signs? You're much better at drawing than me. And Ms Chen says every class needs its own table. Can you bring one?

Amir: Sure. I'll do the signs this weekend, and I'll ask my dad about a table. He's got a folding one at home. **[pause]**

Mei: Thank you!

Amir: Where will we get the plants?

Mei: My aunt has a flower shop. She'll give us forty plants for 200 yuan. **[pause]**

Amir: And how much will we sell them for?

Mei: Ten yuan each. If we sell all of them, we'll get 400 yuan. After we pay my aunt, there will be 200 yuan for the charity. **[pause]**

Amir: Great. Oh, but I can only come in the morning. I have a piano lesson at one o'clock. **[pause]**

Mei: That's fine. And I'm really happy about the main gate.

Amir: Me too. Everybody will walk past us when they come in!

Answers. One mark each. Spelling does not matter if the meaning is clear. Answers must be in English.

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
1	**B** plants		A (cakes): heard "cakes" but missed "but the Year 9 classes are already doing that".
2	**C** 2:00		A (10:00) is the start; B (1:00) is Amir's piano lesson.
3	**B** (by the main gate)		A: last year's place, next to the music stage.
4	**Both** make the price signs **and** bring a table		One correct only, or three or more ticked: 0. "Buy the plants" (the aunt gives them) and "play the piano" (his lesson) are distractors.
5	**40**	forty	200 (the cost).
6	**200**	200 yuan, ¥200	400: heard the takings but not "after we pay my aunt".
7	He has a piano lesson at one o'clock (and the fair goes on until two).	He has a piano lesson; he has to go to piano.	"He is drawing the signs"; "He is busy" with no reason.
8	Everybody walks past the main gate when they come in, so more people will see the stall.	It is not next to the music stage, so it is quieter and people can hear them; more customers.	"Because it is near the gate" with no reason; "because it is big".

Part B: Dr Lin's talk about noise in cities (questions 9 to 16, about 7 minutes)

Say: "Now turn to Part B on page 4. I am going to read a short talk by a scientist, Dr Lin. She is talking to a class about noise in cities. I will read it two times. First, read questions 9 to 16. You have one minute." After one minute, say: "Now listen. You can answer while I read."

Read it twice at the steady pace in Section 2 (about 160 words a minute), as a teacher would give a short talk. Pause for about 2 seconds at each [pause]. After the first reading, say "Now listen again" and read it again. After the second reading, give one minute to finish. Do not repeat any part, do not explain any word, and do not answer questions about the talk. Practise the talk aloud once before the day. Say these words clearly: **decibels** (DESS-ih-bels), **adrenaline** (a-DREN-a-lin), **chronic** (KRON-ik), **Munich** (MYOO-nik).

About the talk (for the English team). 389 words in 25 sentences (average 15.6 words); 19% of the words are outside the 2000 most common English word forms (15% after simple ending rules, names left out; method as in `02_Listening_Evidence_Statement`, Section 6). Features: a process and a chain of cause and effect (questions 11 and 15), comparisons and contrasts (a fountain and a street; the old and new airports), numbers and a statistic, subject words explained in passing (decibels, hormones, chronic), a correction ("Actually, that's not quite right", question 10), an opinion that is implied, not stated (question 14), and discourse markers (as a result, however, whereas, on the other hand, interestingly). The facts are simplified but sound: decibels and loudness, the stress response, European traffic noise figures and the Munich airport study (children's reading and memory near the old and new airports, 1992 onwards).

Script: Dr Lin's talk about noise in cities

Good morning, everyone. I'm Dr Lin, and I study how cities affect people's health. Today I want to talk about something most of us hardly notice: noise. **[pause]**

We measure noise in decibels, a unit that tells us how loud a sound is. A quiet library is about forty decibels, a normal conversation is about sixty, and a busy road can reach eighty. People often say that ten more decibels make a sound ten times louder. Actually, that's not quite right. Ten more decibels means ten times more energy, but to our ears the sound only seems about twice as loud. **[pause]**

So why does noise matter for health? When a sudden sound reaches your ears, your brain treats it as a warning of danger, even while you are concentrating on something else. As a result, your body releases stress hormones such as adrenaline, which make your heart beat faster and raise your blood pressure. This reaction helped our ancestors escape from predators, but in a city it can happen hundreds of times a day. Noise that continues for months or years is called chronic noise, and doctors have linked it to heart disease. **[pause]**

Across Europe, one in five people live with traffic noise loud enough to harm their health. Noise affects learning, too: when Munich moved its airport in 1992, researchers tested children living near the old airport and the new one. Near the new airport, the children's reading and memory became worse, whereas near the old airport, which was now quiet, they improved. **[pause]**

Interestingly, loudness is not the whole story. A fountain can be almost as loud as a busy street. However, most people find the sound of running water relaxing, while traffic makes them tense. **[pause]**

So what can cities do? Electric cars are often presented as the answer. They are certainly quieter in slow traffic, but above about forty kilometres an hour, most noise comes from the tyres, not the engine. On the other hand, lower speed limits and quieter road surfaces help more than most people expect. **[pause]**

In one new park beside a motorway, the noise level is only slightly lower than before, but the designers added several fountains, and visitors say they feel calmer there. **[pause]**

So next time someone tells you that cities are simply noisy places, ask them: does it have to be that way?

Answers. One mark for each question; questions 12 and 13 are one mark each. Spelling does not matter if the meaning is clear. Answers must be in English.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
9	Detail: a number	**60**	sixty; 60 decibels	40 (a quiet library) or 80 (a busy road): heard the list of numbers but not which sound each one belongs to.
10	Detail: a correction	**about twice as loud**		"about ten times as loud": heard "People often say ..." but missed the correction "Actually, that's not quite right". "A hundred times" is not said.
11	Process (sequence)	Your brain treats the sound as a warning of danger **2** · Your body releases stress hormones **3** · Your heart beats faster **4**		All three correct for the mark. Heart before hormones: heard the words but not the chain of cause and effect ("As a result ... which make your heart beat faster").
12	Note completion	**memory**	memories; any spelling that is clear (memery, memori)	"reading" (already in the notes); "learning" (said in the sentence before); "worse".

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
13	Note completion	**improved**	got better; became better; were better; went up	"got worse" (the new airport); "quiet" (the old airport became quiet, not the children's results); "the same".
14	Speaker's attitude (implied)	**She thinks they help, but other changes may help more.**		"the best way to make cities quieter": the view she reports ("often presented as the answer") but does not share. "noisier": misheard "most noise comes from the tyres".
15	Inference joining two parts of the talk	The park has fountains, and (as Dr Lin said earlier) most people find the sound of running water relaxing, while traffic makes them tense. So the park feels calmer even though it is almost as loud.	They hear water, which is relaxing; the sound of the fountains is nicer or calmer than traffic; the fountains are relaxing; the pleasant water sound covers the traffic	"Because it is quieter" (she says the level is only slightly lower); "because there are fountains" with no idea of the sound being relaxing or pleasant; "because of the trees" (not said).
16	Main purpose	**to show that noise harms health, and that cities do not have to be so noisy**		"how scientists measure sound" and "noise in different cities in Europe" are single details; "electric cars will solve the problem of noise" is the opposite of her view.

Band guide v2 (listening, / 16). Use the part scores, in this order:

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 2	**A**
Part A 3 to 4	**B**
Part A 5 to 6, or Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 0 to 2	**C**
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 3 to 5	**D**
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 6 to 8	**E**

Part A places a student in bands A to C; Part B separates C, D and E. If Part B is well above what Part A suggests (for example Part A 5, Part B 6), look for a slip in Part A, use judgement, and compare with "listening in conversation" on the Interview sheet.

What to look for

- **Part A:** questions 1 to 4 each have a distractor that is mentioned in the conversation. Choosing the distractor every time shows a listener catching single words, not following the exchange: typical of band B. Question 6 needs the student to hear a correction ("after we pay my aunt"); questions 7 and 8 need inference across two turns.
- **Part B** is at the level of a lesson for a fluent student of 12 to 13. A fluent Year 8 listener usually scores 6 or more. Questions 10 and 14 test whether the student follows how the speaker positions an idea: a listener who catches single words chooses "ten times" and "the best way". Question 15 joins two parts of the talk, and question 16 the whole talk.
- **English barrier or something else?** A strong Part A with a weak Part B means the student copes with everyday English but not yet with academic English: plan support for subject language in lessons. This is different from a low Part A. If a student scores low in both but understood you well in conversation, note it on the Reading front sheet and compare with the interview.

3.2 Reading paper (15 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Reading pages. Read the texts and answer the questions. There are two parts. Part B is harder than Part A. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 15 minutes." Start the timer. Do not read the

texts or questions aloud, and do not explain words. You may repeat this instruction. Give a two-minute warning.

Mark scheme. Spelling and grammar are not marked in reading answers if the meaning is clear. Answers copied from the text are fine when they answer the question. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

Part A: Greenway Sports Centre (a notice; very accessible, with pictures; version 1 Part A, unchanged)

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
1	8:00	8, 8 am, eight o'clock	7:00 (the weekday time)
2	15 yuan	15, ¥15	30
3	People aged 16 and over	16 and over; over 16; 16+; people who are 16 or older	"Adults" (not what the notice says); "students"
4	A 2 yuan coin	2 yuan; a coin	"A student card"
5	a False · b True · c False		1 mark for each correct row (3 marks)
6	30 yuan	30, ¥30, 15 + 15	15 (one ticket); 60 (adult price)

Part B: Sleep: why teenagers need more of it (non-fiction, age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 12; version 1 Part C, renumbered: version 1 questions 14 to 20 are now 7 to 13)

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
7	Retrieval	8 to 10 hours	between eight and ten hours	13; "a lot"
8	Inference	Teenagers' bodies release melatonin (the chemical that makes us sleepy) later, up to two hours later.	Their body clock changes; the sleepy chemical comes later; blue light from phones tells the brain it is still daytime	"They are lazy"; "they have homework" with no link to feeling sleepy
9	Vocabulary in context	very tired		
10	Retrieval (2)	Go to bed at about the same time every day · Put your phone in another room an hour before bed		**1 mark for each correct tick.** Take off 1 mark for each wrong tick beyond two boxes (minimum 0).
11	Inference	During deep sleep, the brain sorts and stores what we have learnt.	Sleep helps the brain save or keep information; the brain organises learning while you sleep	"Because they are not tired" with no link to memory
12	Author's purpose	To make teenage readers feel understood (it is not their fault), so they want to read on.	To get the reader's attention; to speak directly to the reader; to surprise the reader; to show it is about biology, not being lazy	"Because teenagers are lazy"
13	Author's purpose	to explain a problem and give advice		

Band guide (version 3.1; use judgement when a result is uneven, and check against the sentence reading screen)

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 3	**A**
Part A 4 or more, Part B 0 to 2	**B**
Part B 3 to 5	**C**
Part B 6 to 8	**D** or **E** (see below)

D or E. Part B is the age-level text, so 6 or more shows at least a competent reader. Give **E** only when Part B is 7 or 8 **and** the sentence reading screen (meaning checks and fluency) and the writing also point to E. Version 3.1 has no text above age level, so the reading paper alone cannot confirm band E.

Record the reading paper marks (Part A, Part B), the band and the question where the student stopped at 15 minutes on the **Reading front sheet**, and give it to the interviewer.

What to look for

- Part B (the sleep article) is age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 12.
- Weaker readers copy a sentence near the key word whether or not it answers the question.
- If a student did not finish Part B in 15 minutes, note it on the Reading front sheet: a slow but accurate reader is different from a student who reached Part B and could not follow it.
- Part B has subject vocabulary (melatonin, releases, developing, alert). Students from Chinese schools often know the science in Chinese; vocabulary, not the idea, is usually the barrier.
- **English barrier or reading difficulty?** If a student reads aloud fluently in the sentence reading screen but scores low here, the gap is vocabulary and comprehension, not decoding. If a student is slow and inaccurate in both, and also reads slowly in Chinese (ask the parents), note a possible reading difficulty on the Reading front sheet.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Writing page. Choose one task and tick it. Plan in the box first. Then write. Try to write about 20 lines. You have 10 minutes." You may repeat the instruction. Do not explain the prompts.

The tasks

- **Task 1 (descriptive):** describe a busy place you know well, for example a train station at Spring Festival, a night market or a sports match.
- **Task 2 (persuasive):** a speech to the class persuading students to waste less food in the school canteen.

Marking. Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 are between the descriptions). Total / 16. Then give the band by **best fit** with the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, using the total only as a check.

Criterion	0	2	4
Content and organisation	Nothing in English, or isolated words; no link to the task.	A short response that follows the task; a list of things seen, or of reasons, with simple links ("and", "also"); little development; little paragraphing.	Well shaped for the age: the description builds a clear picture through the senses and has a focus (a moment, a mood); the speech has a clear position, two or three developed reasons with examples, a call to action and an awareness of the audience ("we", "you"); paragraphs.
Vocabulary	Single memorised words or copied words.	Everyday words used correctly; some repetition; gaps filled with simple words or Chinese.	A wide range, chosen for effect: precise nouns, verbs and adjectives in the description; persuasive language in the speech (rhetorical questions, "imagine", "surely", "every day we ..."); words for linking ideas.
Grammar and sentences	No sentences.	Simple sentences and some joined with "and", "but", "because"; frequent errors (verb tenses, plurals, articles, word order) but meaning is mostly clear.	Varied sentences, including complex ones and some for effect (a short sentence after a long one, a list of three); tenses controlled; errors are rare and do not affect meaning.
Spelling and punctuation	Spelling makes most words hard to read; no punctuation.	Common words spelt correctly; longer words phonetically plausible; full stops and capital letters used, not always correctly.	Accurate spelling, including most longer words; sentence punctuation secure; commas in lists and after openings, question and exclamation marks, apostrophes mostly correct.

Rough guide to the total (best fit decides): 0 to 3 **A** · 4 to 7 **B** · 8 to 10 **C** · 11 to 13 **D** · 14 to 16 **E**.

Band E writing at Year 8. Comparable to a fluent writer of 12 or 13. In 10 minutes, usually 180 to 280 words in clear paragraphs. The description goes beyond a list: it uses the senses, chooses details and creates an atmosphere. The speech addresses its audience, argues with reasons and examples and ends with a clear call to action. Sentences are

varied and controlled, vocabulary is precise and sometimes ambitious, and errors are few and minor. Judge quality, not just length.

What to look for

- Typical features of Chinese-speaking learners (missing past tense -ed or plural -s, "a" and "the", "he" and "she" mixed, "very" for every intensifier) are normal stages of learning English. Score them under grammar, but read past them to judge content.
- Memorised phrases from textbooks or exam practice ("As we all know", "In a word", "Last but not least") are common: they show learning, but judge the writing on what the student does with them.
- Writing much weaker than speaking is common in students from oral-heavy English courses; writing much stronger than speaking is common in students taught mainly through grammar and textbook dialogues.

3.4 Speaking and sentence reading (the interview, 15 minutes)

The interview is 1:1. The questions and the speaking band descriptors are in the **Interviewer guide** (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y7_Y10`), and the record is the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y7_Y10`). It opens with the **Graded Sentence Reading Screen**: the rules, your copy of the sentences and the meaning questions, and the reading age table are in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`; the student reads from `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`; the results go on the **Reading front sheet**. For Year 8, **start at Level 7 (sentence 19)**, and follow the rules in the guide for going back, stopping, the meaning checks and fluency. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1. Then use the interview questions (school and learning, interests, friends and wellbeing, future plans and aspirations, values, an opinion question) and give the **speaking band** with the descriptors in the Interviewer guide, recording it on the Interview sheet.

Pace. Ask the questions at the pace in Section 2 (about 160 words a minute), the same for every candidate.

The Interviewer guide's opinion questions (homework, phones) do not overlap with the writing tasks above.

4. Maths (25 minutes, 30 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Maths pages. There are three sections. Section A is calculation and algebra. Section B is word questions: read each one carefully and decide what to do. Section C is problems with pictures, tables and a map. You cannot use a calculator. Show your working in the boxes: you can get marks for your working. I can read any question to you. Just ask. You have 25 minutes."

Read any question aloud on request, as often as asked, and point to the picture. Follow the access rules (Section 2): mark **L** if a Chinese-speaking colleague gave a question once in Chinese, and **NT** if the student says they have not learnt the topic. **Section B is the evidence for the maths profile:** if you see a student stop at a word question, you may offer once, quietly, to read it aloud in English. Note on the grading sheet which word questions were read aloud and which were given in Chinese (L).

Marking. Accept any clear, correct method. A correct answer with no working scores full marks, except in questions 14 and 18, where the working is the answer. Accept equivalent answers (for example 1/4 for 0.25) unless the question asks for a form (index form in question 1, standard form in question 9). Where a method mark is shown, give it for a correct method with one arithmetic slip. **ft** (follow through): where a later step uses an earlier wrong answer correctly, give the later mark. Where units are printed on the paper, a missing unit does not lose a mark. Explanations must be in English; short phrases with numbers are enough.

Section A: Fluency (10 marks). Calculation and algebra, no context. Questions 1 to 4 are at the level expected on entry to Year 8; questions 5 to 9 are Year 8 content.

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
1	$2^3 \times 3^2 \times 5$	1	Any order. $2 \times 2 \times 2 \times 3 \times 3 \times 5$ (correct, but not in index form) scores 0: note it, because only the notation is missing. $2^3 \times 45$ or $8 \times 9 \times 5$ score 0 (not all prime).	Prime factorisation; index notation
2	a 12 · b 840	1 + 1	a: 6, 4, 3 or 2 are common factors but not the highest. b: 10 080 (84 × 120) is a common multiple but not the lowest.	HCF and LCM
3	37%, 3/8, 0.38, 2/5	1	All four in order. Equivalents are fine (0.37, 0.375, 0.38, 0.4). 3/8 placed after 0.38 means 3/8 was taken as 0.38, or the digits were compared without converting.	Fraction, decimal and percentage equivalence
4	$4x - 7$	1	$-7 + 4x$. $4x - 23$ means -2×-4 was taken as -8 (the commonest error). The expansion without simplifying ($6x - 15 - 2x + 8$) scores 0.	Expanding brackets and simplifying
5	$6x(2x - 3y)$	1	$6(2x^2 - 3xy)$, $3x(4x - 6y)$ and $2x(6x - 9y)$ are correct but not fully factorised: 0, note "partly".	Factorising (Year 8)
6	$x = 6$	1	$8x - 12 = 3x + 18$ seen and then a slip: 0 (one mark only), but note the method. $x = 1.8$ means only the first term in each bracket was multiplied ($8x - 3 = 3x + 6$).	Equations with brackets and the unknown on both sides (Year 8)
7	$x < 3$	1	$3 > x$. $x > 3$ means the inequality was not reversed after dividing by -3 (very common). $x = 3$, or 3 alone, scores 0.	Solving a linear inequality (Year 8)
8	y^7	1	y^2 means the powers in $(y^4)^3$ were added, not multiplied.	Index laws (Year 8)
9	1.2×10^9	1	12×10^8 and 1 200 000 000 have the right value but are not in standard form: 0, note it. 12×10^{15} means the powers were multiplied.	Standard form (Year 8 to 9: ceiling item)

Section B: Word questions (8 marks). Words only, no diagrams: the student must read the sentences and set up the maths. Any correct method earns full marks (an equation, a bar model, a reasoned trial); a correct equation earns the method mark.

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
10	80 (degrees)	2	**1 mark** for $4x + 20 = 180$, or $x = 40$ seen. $x = 40$ as the final answer scores 1 (solved but did not answer the question); 60 ($x + 20$) with $x = 40$ seen scores 1.	Angles in a triangle; forming and solving an equation
11	40	2	**1 mark** for a correct equation ($n + (n + 2) + (n + 4) = 114$, or $3n + 6 = 114$), or 36 or 38 seen, or $114 \div 3 = 38$. 39 (from 37, 38 and 39: consecutive numbers, not consecutive even numbers) scores 1.	Consecutive integers; forming an equation
12	¥96	2	**1 mark** for 12 seen (one part: $24 \div 2$), or Amir ¥36, or Sofia ¥60. 64 (¥24 taken as Amir's 3 parts) or 38.4 (¥24 taken as Sofia's share) score 0.	Ratio: using the difference between the parts
13	48 (cm²)	2	**1 mark** for $3w - 4 = w + 4$, or width 4, or length 12, or the square's side 8 seen. 64 (the square's area) or 32 (the rectangle's perimeter) with width 4 and length 12 seen score 1.	Forming and solving an equation with the unknown on both sides; area

Section C: Applied problems (12 marks). Multi-step problems in real contexts, with a diagram, table or map in every question. Question 18 (a garden sprinkler) is the unfamiliar context; questions 14, 17b and 18 ask the student to explain or show.

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
14	**No.** Shop A: 600 → 480 → ¥432. Shop B: ¥420. Shop B is ¥12 cheaper.	2	**1 mark** for 432 and 420 both seen, or one of them with a correct method for the other. **2 marks** for "No" (ticked or written) with both prices, or with an equivalent reason (0.8 × 0.9 = 0.72, so Shop A takes off 28%, not 30%). "No" with no working, or "Yes": 0. "Yes, both are 30% off" (adding the percentages) is the classic error: note it. If a student finds 20% of 600 = 120 and stops, the word "off" may be the barrier: read it aloud.	Percentage decrease; successive percentages; best value; explaining
15	a 0.25 · b 60	1 + 1	a: 1/4, 25%. 0.75 is red and blue together. b: 15 ÷ 0.25, or 15 × 4. ft 15 ÷ (their a) if it gives a whole number. 3.75 (15 × 0.25) scores 0. (The bag has 18 red, 27 blue and 15 green counters.)	Probabilities add up to 1; probability and frequency
16	9:58	3	**1 mark** for the real distance: 4.5 km (or 4500 m, or 450 000 cm) from 9 cm × 50 000. **1 mark** for the time: 18 minutes (or 0.3 hours), ft their distance ÷ 15. **1 mark** for the arrival time, ft 9:40 + their minutes. Accept 09:58, 9.58, 9:58 am. 45 km (450 000 cm taken as 45 km) gives 3 hours and 12:40: scores 2 (ft). One length only (for example 3 cm) loses the first mark; ft the rest. 0.3 hours taken as 30 minutes loses the second mark; 10:10 then earns the third.	Map scales; converting units; speed, distance and time
17	a 2.2 · b Jun did not use how many students read each number of books: he must multiply by the numbers of students and divide by 20, not 5.	2 + 1	a: **1 mark** for 44 seen (the total number of books), or for at least three correct products (1 × 5, 2 × 6, 3 × 5, 4 × 3); **2 marks** for 2.2. 44 as the final answer, or 8.8 (44 ÷ 5): 1. b: any clear statement that Jun ignored the numbers of students, or that there are 20 students, not 5, or that more students read 2 or 3 books than 0. "He added it wrong" or "the answer is 2.2" alone: 0.	Mean from a frequency table; explaining a mistake
18	Circle: 3.14 × 3 × 3 = 28.26 m². Lawn: 6 × 6 = 36 m². Three quarters of 36 = 27 m². 28.26 > 27, so more than three quarters of the lawn gets water.	2	**1 mark** for both areas: 28.26 (or 9π, or 28.3) and 36. **2 marks** for a correct comparison with a conclusion: 28.26 > 27; or 28.26 ÷ 36 = 0.785 (78.5%) > 75%; or the dry part is 7.74 m², less than a quarter (9 m²). Also accept 9π > 9 × 3 = 27, because π > 3. The circumference (18.84) or the diameter used as the radius (113.04): 0, note it.	Area of a circle in context; showing a result (unfamiliar context)

Totals and sub-scores: Fluency (Section A, questions 1 to 9) / 10 · **Word questions** (Section B, questions 10 to 13) / 8 · **Applied** (Section C, questions 14 to 18) / 12 · **Total** / 30.

Reading the profile. Work out each sub-score as a percentage and compare them. A gap of about 30 percentage points or more is worth noting.

Profile	What it usually means	What to do
Fluency high, word questions much lower	The English of the questions, not the maths, is the barrier.	Check: read one or two word questions aloud in English and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese (L). If the student then solves them, record on the grading sheet that the barrier is English. Plan support for the language of maths; do not place the student in a lower set for this reason alone.
Fluency and word questions high, applied much lower	The student calculates and sets up problems well but is less practised at multi-step problems, choosing a method and explaining.	Teaching in problem solving and explaining, not more content. Usually suits a high set.
All three high	A strong mathematician.	Note the ceiling items gained (5 to 9, 13, 14, 16 and 18) in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.

Profile	What it usually means	What to do
Fluency low	Many Section A topics are taught in Grade 7 or 8 in China.	Check the NT notes below: a low fluency score that is mostly NT is very different from errors on taught topics (questions 2 and 3).

Band guide v2 (maths, / 30; provisional, for a harder paper): 0 to 10 **1** Below expected · 11 to 16 **2** Working towards · 17 to 22 **3** Expected · 23 to 30 **4** Greater depth, likely top set. (These are under 35%, 35 to 54%, 55 to 74% and 75% or more.) List NT questions, and judge whether the student would reach band 3 once taught.

May not have been taught. A Year 8 entrant from a Chinese mainstream school has usually completed Grade 6 (PEP sequence; other textbooks differ a little, so ask the student). These topics are usually taught in Grade 7 (初一) or later, so the student **may not have been taught** them:

Questions	Topic	Usually taught in China
1	Index notation (powers); prime factorisation written as a product (primes and factors are Grade 5)	Powers: Grade 7. The factor tree is in some textbooks only
4	Expanding brackets and simplifying (letters for numbers is Grade 5)	Grade 7
5	Factorising	Grade 8
6, 13	Equations with brackets and the unknown on both sides (simple equations are Grade 5; question 13 can also be solved by reasoning)	Grade 7
7	Inequalities	Grade 7, second term
8	Index laws	Grade 7 or 8, depending on the textbook
9	Standard form	Grade 7 (large numbers); multiplying in standard form later
15	Probability as a number; probabilities add up to 1 (likelihood in words is Grade 5)	Grade 9
17	The mean from a frequency table (the mean is Grade 4)	Grade 8

Usually **familiar**: HCF and LCM (Grade 5); fractions, decimals and percentages (Grade 6); angles in a triangle (Grade 4); ratio (Grade 6); discounts and percentages of amounts (Grade 6; Chinese textbooks usually describe a discount as the fraction of the price paid, so 20% off is "pay eight tenths"); map scales (Grade 6); speed, distance and time (Grade 4); the area of a circle with π = 3.14 (Grade 6). Questions 10 to 12 need only Grade 5 equations or Grade 6 ratio: they test reading and setting up, not new content.

Not covered in this paper: simple interest, the circumference of a circle and the median and mode are not tested, because 30 marks cannot cover every topic.

What to look for

- **Fluency against word questions.** Questions 6 and 13 are a direct pair (the unknown on both sides, without and with words). A student who gets 6 but not 13, and then solves 13 when it is read aloud, has an English barrier, not a maths gap.
- **Explaining.** Students from Chinese schools often calculate quickly and accurately but write little working. In questions 14, 17b and 18 the explanation is part of the mark: short English with numbers is enough ("No. A is 432, B is 420."). If a student explains well aloud but writes nothing, note it in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet: it shows maths understanding and a writing barrier.
- **Words that can block a maths question:** "off" (14), "without looking" and "altogether" (15), "consecutive" (11, explained on the paper), "average speed" and "scale" (16), "three quarters" and "show that" (18). Note on the grading sheet any question that was solved after it was read aloud.
- A low score that is mostly Grade 7 and 8 number and algebra (1 and 4 to 9) or statistics and probability (15, 17) is very different from a low score on taught topics (2, 3, 10 to 12, 14, 16, 18). Say which in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.

5. Science (8 minutes, 10 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Science pages. There are 7 questions. Some topics may be new to you: that is fine, do what you can. I can read any question to you. You have 8 minutes." The same access rules as maths apply (L and NT). Spelling does not matter in science answers if the word is recognisable.

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
1	a A gas · B solid · C liquid · b It increases.	1 + 1	a: all three for the mark.	The particle model; energy and changes of state
2	A, B or D	1	The name instead of the letter (cell wall, chloroplast, vacuole). C (the nucleus) scores 0: both cells have one.	Animal and plant cells (the picture gives the comparison)
3	C 1 · A 2 · B 3	1	All three for the mark: dissolve, filter, evaporate. A, C, B (filter first) shows the student has not thought about the salt being dissolved.	Separating mixtures; a method in order (working scientifically)
4	a lemon juice · b toothpaste or soap	1 + 1	a: vinegar is an acid but not the strongest. b: pure water is neutral.	Acids, alkalis and the pH scale; reading a table
5	a It stays the same. · b 5 (m/s)	1 + 1	a: "it goes down" is a very common idea (that motion needs an unbalanced force). b: 2000 means distance × time.	Balanced forces; speed = distance ÷ time
6	B	1	C (the most waves) means the student confused loudness with pitch.	Sound as a wave
7	C	1	The anther. A (the stigma) receives pollen.	Reproduction in plants

Band guide (science, / 10; provisional): 0 to 3 **1** · 4 to 5 **2** · 6 to 8 **3** · 9 to 10 **4**.

May not have been taught. A Year 8 entrant has usually done **no secondary science**: in Chinese schools biology starts in Grade 7 (初一), physics in Grade 8 and chemistry in Grade 9. Primary science (科学) covers some of these ideas, but textbooks differ. So a Year 8 entrant **may not have been taught**: the particle model and energy in changes of state (Q1; states of matter are usually familiar from primary science), the parts of plant and animal cells (Q2; microscopes and cells are often met in Grade 6), acids, alkalis and pH (Q4; chemistry, Grade 9), balanced forces and calculating speed (Q5; physics, Grade 8), and sound shown as a wave (Q6; sound and vibration are Grade 4). Separating mixtures by filtering and evaporating (Q3) and the parts of a flower (Q7) are often taught in primary science. Read a low science score with these notes, and judge the student's scientific thinking from questions 2, 3, 4 and 5b.

Not covered in this paper: energy stores and transfers are tested only through heating and changes of state (Q1b), and light waves are not tested, because 10 marks cannot cover every Year 7 topic.

What to look for

- Questions 2, 3 and 4 can be answered from the picture or the table with careful reading and reasoning, even if the topic is new: a student who gets them is thinking scientifically.
- One-word answers are fine. Answers must be in English; an explanation in Chinese scores 0.

6. Recording the results

1. **Mark the student paper.** Every question has a mark box.
2. **Copy the totals onto the grading sheet** (`Y08_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`) and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance). Record there too whether Part B of the listening was given, the maths sub-scores and profile (Section 4), the NT topics and L questions, the writing task chosen, any access arrangements and your comment.
3. **Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`): the reading paper marks (Part A, Part B), the band and the question where the student stopped at 15 minutes.
4. **Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet** before the interview.
5. **After the interview, put together** the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days. The overall English band is the band most of the four skills sit in: name any skill that is two or more bands below the others.
6. **File the marked student paper with them** (or shred it under the school's policy).

Interviewer guide: Years 7 to 10

This guide is reusable. Nothing is written on it: keep one in the room, in a folder or laminated. Ratings and notes for each student go on the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y7_Y10`).

About 15 minutes, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the student's spoken English (the speaking band), to get to know the student (interests, learning, wellbeing, **future plans and aspirations**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme. It opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (3 to 5 minutes; start Level 6 for Year 7, 7 for Year 8, 8 for Year 9, 9 for Year 10; follow `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide` and write the points on the Reading front sheet, `forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

How to ask. Start with the main question. If the student struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, or a choice). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. This lets every student show their best English. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. Answers must be in English.

Pace of speech. Speak at a steady, clear pace: about 160 to 185 words a minute (Year 7 about 160, Year 8 about 160, Year 9 about 175, Year 10 about 185). Use the same pace for every candidate in the year group, and use it for the instructions and meaning questions of the sentence reading too. Do not rush: wait at least five seconds before rephrasing.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a student tells you something that worries you about their safety or wellbeing, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Questions (10 minutes)

Choose about two questions from each block. On the Interview sheet, write short notes under "Key things the student said": what they said, and how they said it.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
Warm-up	Tell me a little about yourself.	What is your name? How old are you? Where do you live?	What would your friends say about you?
	How did you travel here today?	Did you come by car?	What do you like or dislike about your city?
School and learning	Tell me about your school now.	Do you like your school? What is your favourite subject?	What is the biggest difference you expect between your school and ours?
	Which subject do you find hardest? What do you do when work is difficult?	Is maths easy or hard for you?	Tell me about a time you kept going when something was hard.
	How do you learn English now?	Do you have English lessons? Do you read in English?	What helps you most when you learn new words?
	How do you feel about learning all your subjects in English?	Are you worried, excited, or both?	What will be hardest, and how will you deal with it?
Interests	What do you enjoy doing outside school?	Do you like sport, music or art?	What have you achieved in it that you are proud of?
	Tell me about a book, film or game you enjoyed.	Do you like reading? What kind of books?	Why did it stay in your mind?
	Do you take part in any clubs, competitions, volunteering or service?	Do you help at home or in your community?	What did you learn from it?
Friends and wellbeing	Who do you spend time with at school?	Do you have good friends?	How do you help a friend who is having a bad day?

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
	How do you relax when you feel tired or stressed?	What makes you happy?	How do you balance study, activities and rest?
	How many classes or tutoring sessions do you have after school?	Do you have classes at the weekend?	How do you feel about how busy you are?
Future plans and aspirations	What would you like to do in the future?	Do you have a dream job?	What steps would get you there?
	Where would you like to study after school, and what would you study?	China or another country?	Why does that place or subject interest you?
	Why do you want to join the international programme? Whose idea was it?	Is it your idea or your parents' idea?	What do you hope it will give you that your school now does not?
	What kind of person do you want to be at our school?	Do you want to join clubs?	What could you give to our school community?
Values (choose one)	A classmate asks to copy your homework. What do you do?	Is it OK to copy homework?	Why does honesty matter in learning?
	A new student is sitting alone at lunch. What do you do?	Would you talk to them?	Why might someone find it hard to join a group?
Opinion (to hear extended speaking)	Should students have homework every day? Why, or why not?	Do you like homework?	What would be a better system? Give an example.
	Should phones be allowed in school?	Do you use a phone at school now?	What are the strongest arguments on the other side?
Year 10 only	Which IGCSE subjects would you like to take, and why?	Which subjects do you like best?	How do they connect to your future plans?
	The IGCSE course takes two years. How will you manage starting a new course in English?	Will it be hard for you?	What support will you look for, and from whom?
Questions for us	What would you like to ask me about the school?	Do you have any questions?	

2. Speaking band

Choose the band that fits best, using the evidence from the whole interview, and tick it on the Interview sheet. Rate **listening in conversation** (how much of your English they understood) with the same letters. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	Little or no spoken English, or single memorised words and phrases ("I am fine"). Relies on Chinese, gesture or silence. Understands very little unless supported.
B Early acquisition	Short answers and simple memorised sentences on familiar topics (family, school, likes). Frequent errors in word order, verbs and plurals. Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions.
C Developing competence	Answers most main questions with connected sentences, using "because", "but", "so". Errors are frequent but meaning is usually clear. Vocabulary is everyday; searches for words on less familiar topics. Can give a short opinion with a reason.
D Competent	Speaks at length on most questions, explains and gives examples, handles the stretch prompts with some effort. Errors are occasional and rarely affect meaning. Some subject and abstract vocabulary.
E Fluent	Speaks as fluently and accurately as a fluent English speaker of the same age. Handles abstract and hypothetical questions easily, with a wide vocabulary.

3. Suitability

Rate each strand on the Interview sheet from what you saw and heard: **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence: a short quotation or something you observed.

Strand	What strong looks like
Attitude to learning and resilience	Wants to learn, has a go, keeps going when work is hard, talks about effort and improvement
Curiosity and engagement	Asks questions, shows interest in ideas beyond the textbook, enjoys discussion
Social and emotional readiness	Relaxed or able to settle, makes eye contact (allowing for culture and shyness), talks about friends, manages feelings, ready for a change of school
Independence and self-management	Organises themselves, can describe how they study, manages time and activities, will ask for help
Values and conduct	Kind, honest and respectful in the interview and in the values question
Readiness for English-medium learning	Motivated to learn in English, willing to speak even with mistakes, has strategies for new words
Clarity and ownership of future plans	Has thought about what comes next, the plans are their own as well as the family's, understands why the international programme fits

Boarding readiness (only if the student will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness, experience of being away from home. Rate it on the Interview sheet in the same way.

4. Anything to follow up

Tick any that apply on the Interview sheet, and add a note:

- Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision)
- Wellbeing (for example anxiety, low mood, very heavy workload, sleep)
- Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)
- Medical or dietary
- Mismatch between the student's wishes and the family's plans

Receiving homeroom teacher (optional). If the student's likely homeroom teacher meets them, they note first impressions and what the student would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy who speaks Chinese, a vocabulary book for each subject, a quiet check-in each morning) on the Interview sheet.

To finish. On the Interview sheet, write your comment for the final mark sheet (strengths, concerns, support), and sign and date it.

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: interviewer guide

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 10. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this guide (the sentences are in Section 5), the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`), a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening). This guide is reusable: nothing is written on it. Write every point, meaning mark, total and result on the Reading front sheet.

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

Pace of speech. When you give the instructions and ask the meaning questions, speak slowly and clearly, especially with the younger students. Aim for about 120 words a minute in Years 1 and 2, 120 in Year 3, 130 in Year 4, 140 in Year 5, 155 in Year 6, 160 in Year 7, 160 in Year 8, 175 in Year 9 and 185 in Year 10. Use the same pace for every candidate in a year group, and do not rush.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said on the Reading front sheet. Patterns (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in Section 5), at the pace described in Section 1. Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Mark ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood) on the Reading front sheet. The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is marked ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**, and write the rating on the Reading front sheet.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Interviewer's copy of the sentences

The student reads from the card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`). Follow this copy as they read, and write the points (2, 1 or 0 for each sentence), the meaning mark and the level total on the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

No.	Sentence (Level 1)
1	I can see a red bus.
2	The cat sat on my bed.
3	Dad has a big hat.
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*

No.	Sentence (Level 2)
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.
6	They like to play in the park.
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*

No.	Sentence (Level 3)
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*

No.	Sentence (Level 4)
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*

No.	Sentence (Level 5)
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*

No.	Sentence (Level 6)
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*

No.	Sentence (Level 7)
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*

No.	Sentence (Level 8)
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*

No.	Sentence (Level 9)
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*

No.	Sentence (Level 10)
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*

No.	Sentence (Level 11)
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*

No.	Sentence (Level 12)
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Write on the Reading front sheet: total points, reading age, actual age (years:months), the difference (reading age minus actual age), meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓) and fluency rating (1 to 4).

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 10 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 10
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Write on the Reading front sheet: the indicative band, and one line on patterns noticed.